

A rectangular chalkboard with a dark brown wooden frame is mounted on a light gray wall. The word 'Phishing' is written in a large, white, serif font, with a horizontal line underneath it. Below the line, the words 'Case Studies' are written in a smaller, white, serif font.

Phishing

Case Studies

Case Study 1: The Google & Facebook Invoice Scam

- Between 2013 and 2015, a Lithuanian attacker tricked employees at Google and Facebook into sending over \$100 million to fake companies through carefully crafted phishing emails.
 - He posed as a legitimate hardware vendor.
 - Sent real-looking invoices and contracts.
 - Used domain names that looked nearly identical to the real vendor.



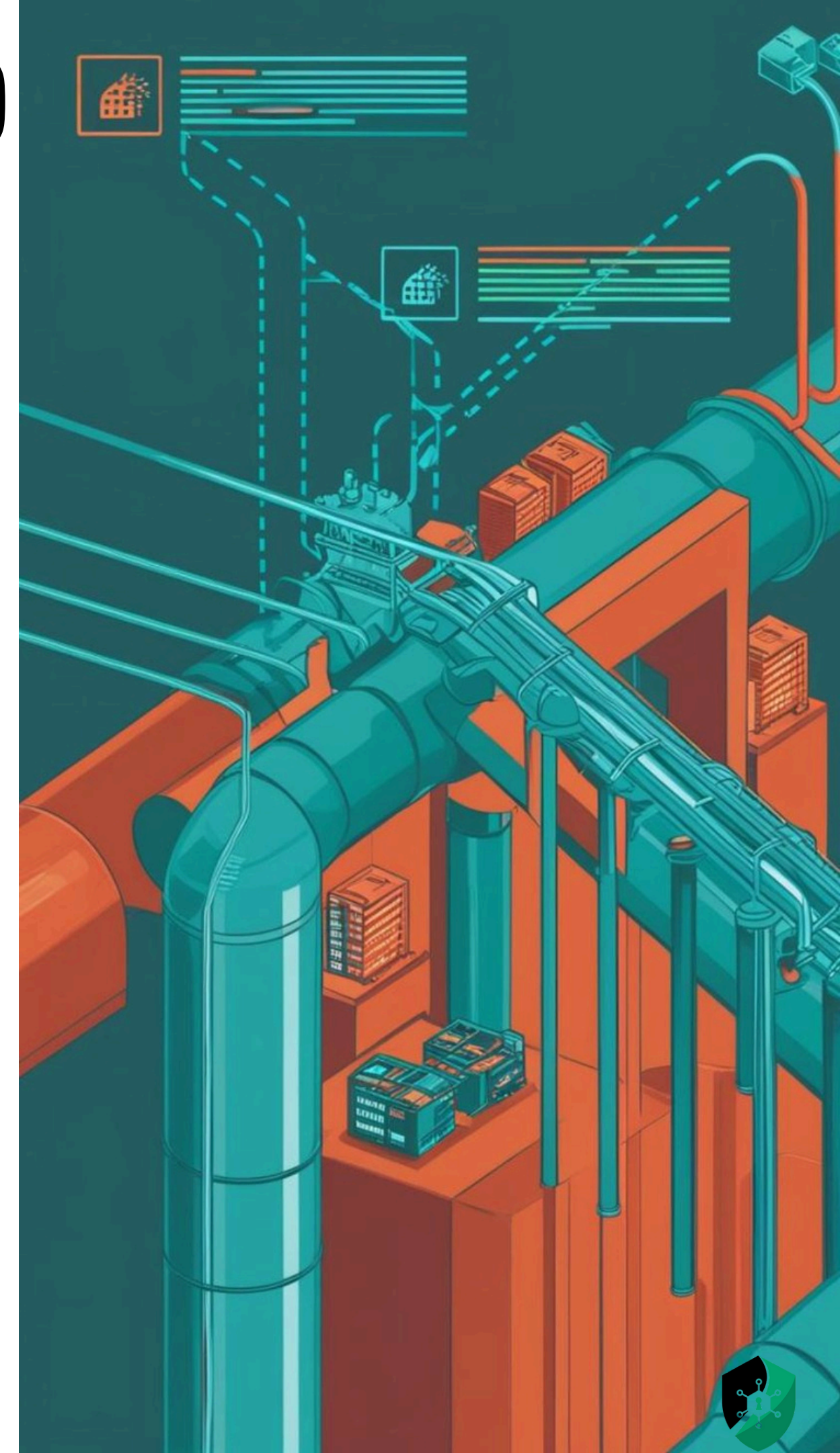
Case Study 1: The Google & Facebook Invoice Scam

- Result:
 - Both companies paid the fake invoices without realizing they were being scammed.
- Key Takeaway:
 - Even tech giants with top cybersecurity teams can fall for phishing when attackers target human behavior.



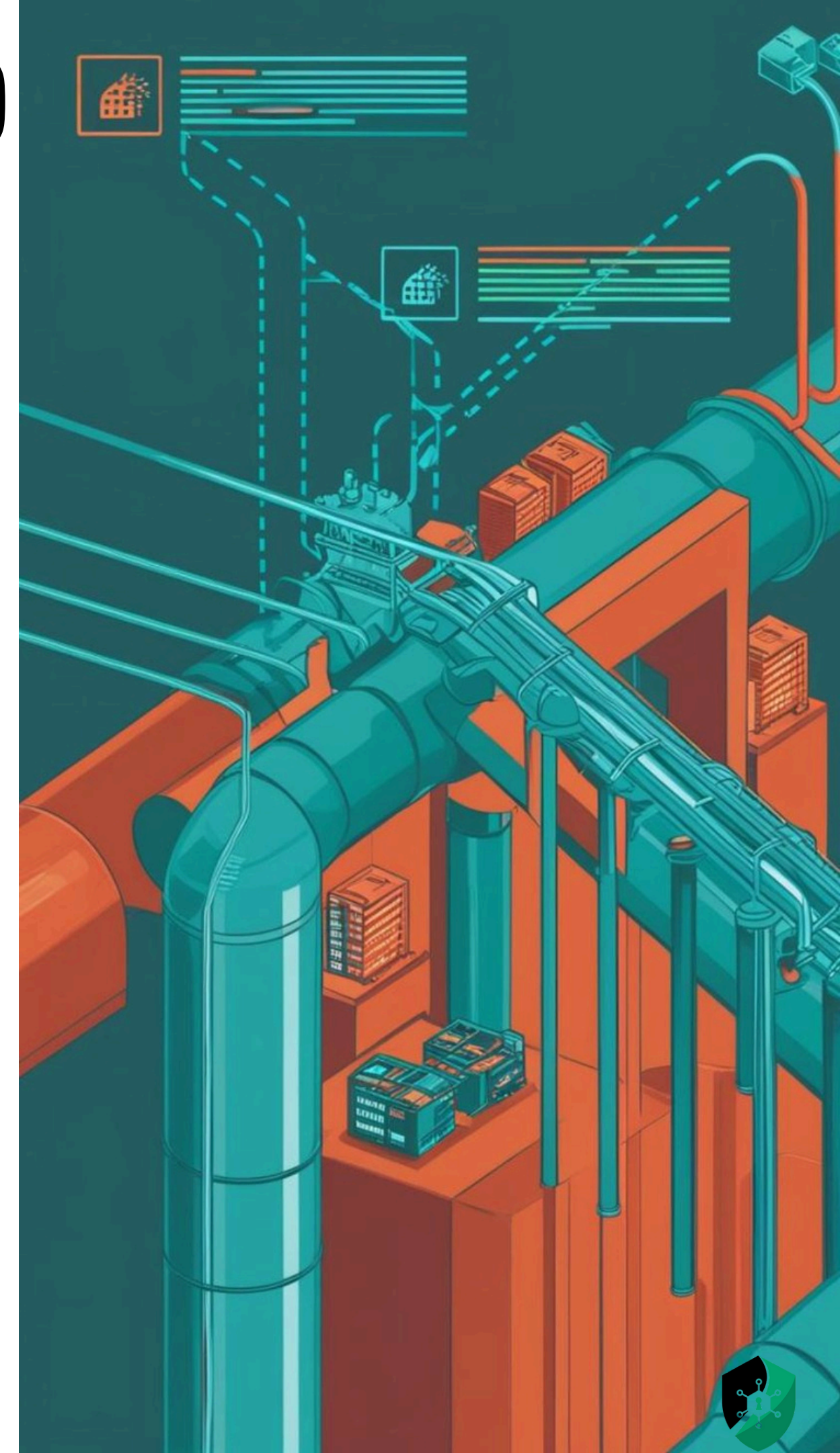
Case Study 2: Colonial Pipeline Ransomware Attack (2021)

- What Happened:
 - A single stolen password—likely obtained through phishing—was used to access Colonial Pipeline's network.
 - Ransomware was deployed, crippling the company's operations.
 - The pipeline shut down for days, affecting fuel supply across the U.S.



Case Study 2: Colonial Pipeline Ransomware Attack (2021)

- Result:
 - The company paid a \$4.4 million ransom.
 - Government agencies and consumers were impacted.
- Key Takeaway:
 - One compromised login can take down national infrastructure.



Case Study 3: NHS Email Phishing (UK)

- What Happened:
 - NHS staff received emails pretending to be from HR with links to “new COVID-19 guidelines.”
 - The link led to a fake login page, stealing staff credentials.



Case Study 3: NHS Email Phishing (UK)

- Result:
 - Attackers accessed internal NHS systems and attempted to launch follow-up attacks.
 - Investigation revealed multiple healthcare workers were tricked.
- Key Takeaway:
 - Attackers exploit fear, urgency, and trust—especially during crises.



Case Study 4: Personal Email Phishing – Tax Refund Scam

- What Happened:
 - A user received an email claiming to be from the IRS offering a tax refund.
 - The email linked to a fake IRS site requesting Social Security and banking info.



Case Study 4: Personal Email Phishing – Tax Refund Scam

- Result:
 - The victim's identity was stolen and bank accounts drained.
 - Recovery took months and required legal help.
- Key Takeaway:
 - Phishing affects individuals too—not just companies.



Patterns Across All Cases:

- The emails looked legitimate.
- The attacks succeeded because someone clicked or replied.
- The costs were massive—financially, operationally, and emotionally.

Phishing Case Studies

